“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 17

The Pastimes of Śrī Caitanya in His Youth

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I bow down to Śrī Caitanya, whose ways are free and wondrous. By His grace even *yavanas* (those outside Vedic culture), loudly chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa, become like the gods.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have listed the pastimes of His *kaiśora* age in summary. Now I give in sequence the summary of the pastimes of His youth (*yauvana*).

4 In His youth Gaura sports with learning, beauty, fine dress, enjoyment, dancing and *kīrtana*, and by giving away love of God and the holy name.

5 As He entered youth, His limbs were adorned with divine cloth and divine dress, with garlands and sandalwood paste.

6 In the pride of His learning He took no account of anyone; defeating all the scholars, He taught.

7 On the pretext of a disorder of *vāyu* (the vital air), He manifested love of God, and with His devotees He enjoyed various pastimes.

8 Then the Lord journeyed to Gayā, and there He met Īśvara Purī.

9 After His initiation, love of God became manifest in Him. He returned home, and again love played in Him.

10 He gave love of God to Śacī; then came the meeting with Advaita, who was granted the sight of the universal form.

11 Then Śrīvāsa performed the Lord's *abhiṣeka* (ceremonial bathing), and sitting on a cot, the Lord manifested His divine majesty.

12 Then Nityānanda Svarūpa came. Meeting the Lord, He was granted the sight of the six-armed form.

13 First the Lord showed Him the six-armed form, holding the conch, disc, club, lotus, the bow Śārṅga and the flute.

14 Then He became four-armed, His body bent in three places; with two hands He played the flute, and in the other two He held the conch and disc.

15 Then He was simply two-armed, the flute at His lips — the son of the king of Vraja, dark of body and dressed in yellow.

16 Then came Nityānanda Gosāñi's *vyāsa-pūjā*; and in the mood of Nityānanda, the Lord held the club (*muṣala*).

17 Then Śacī saw the two brothers as Rāma and Kṛṣṇa. Then the Lord delivered Jagāi and Mādhāi.

18 Then for seven *praharas* (twenty-one hours) the Lord remained absorbed in ecstasy, and wherever they were, the devotees saw Him in His special glory.

19 In Murāri's house the Lord was absorbed in the mood of Varāha, and climbing onto Murāri's shoulders, He danced in the courtyard.

20 Then He ate Śuklāmbara's raw rice, and He explained the meaning of the verse "*harer nāma*."

21 "The name of Hari, the name of Hari, only the name of Hari! In Kali there is no other way, no other way, no other way at all." (Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa 38.126)

22 In the age of Kali, Kṛṣṇa descends in the form of the Name; through the Name the whole world is delivered.

23 For firmness the phrase "*harer nāma*" is spoken three times; and to make dull people understand, the word *eva* ("indeed") is added again.

24 The word *kevala* ("only") confirms it once more, excluding knowledge (*jñāna*), *yoga*, austerity and all other practices.

25 Whoever thinks otherwise has no deliverance: "there is no, there is no, there is no" — thrice the word *eva* is spoken.

26 Being lower than a blade of grass, one should always take the Name; free of pride oneself, one should give honor to others.

27 A Vaiṣṇava should practice forbearance like a tree; though scolded or beaten, he should say nothing to anyone.

28 Even when cut down, a tree says nothing; though it withers and dies, it does not ask for water.

29 In the same way a Vaiṣṇava will ask no one for anything. He will live on what comes unasked, or eat vegetables and fruits.

30 He will always take the Name and be content with whatever comes. Such conduct nourishes the path of devotion (*bhakti-dharma*).

31 “More humble than a blade of grass, as forbearing as a tree, seeking no honor and giving honor to others — so one should always glorify Hari.” (Śikṣāṣṭaka 3)

32 With arms upraised I say: Listen, everyone! String this verse on the thread of the Name and wear it on your neck.

33 By the Lord’s order, practice what this verse teaches; then you will surely attain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

34 Then for one whole year the Lord performed *saṅkīrtana* every night in Śrīvāsa’s house.

35 With the doors closed they performed *kīrtana* in deepest absorption. Unbelievers came to mock but could not get in.

36 Hearing the *kīrtana* from outside, they burned with envy, and they devised various schemes to trouble Śrīvāsa.

37–38 One day a brāhmaṇa named Gopāla Cāpāla — a leader among the unbelievers, foul-mouthed and a chatterer — took all the articles for the worship of Bhavānī (Durgā). At night he smeared a spot at Śrīvāsa’s door,

39 and on a banana leaf he placed *oḍa* (hibiscus) flowers, turmeric, vermilion and red sandalwood, and rice.

40 Setting a pot of wine beside them, he went home. In the morning Śrīvāsa saw it all.

41 He called the leading men of the town and, smiling broadly, said to them all:

42 “Every night I worship Bhavānī. See my glory, O respectable brāhmaṇas!”

43 Then all the gentlemen cried out in dismay: “What wicked man has done such a thing here?”

44 They called a sweeper and had everything removed, and had the spot purified with water and cow dung.

45 Three days later that Gopāla Cāpāla was stricken with leprosy all over his body, and blood flowed in streams.

46 Worms covered his whole body and gnawed at him incessantly. The pain was unbearable, and his heart burned with suffering.

47 He stayed sitting under a tree by a bathing place on the Gaṅgā. One day, seeing the Lord, he said:

48 “By village relationship I am Your maternal uncle. Nephew, I am tormented by leprosy.

49 You have descended to deliver all people. I am in great misery — deliver me!”

50 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu grew angry, and in His anger He spoke words of rebuke to him:

51 “O sinner, hater of devotees, I will not deliver you! For ten million births I will have you eaten by worms like this.

52 You made Śrīvāsa out to be a worshiper of Bhavānī. For ten million births you will fall into the hell Raurava.

53 I have descended to destroy the unbelievers. Destroying the unbelievers, I shall spread devotion."

54 Saying this, the Lord went to bathe in the Gaṅgā. The sinner went on suffering, yet his life did not leave him.

55–56 After taking *sannyāsa*, the Lord went to Nīlācala; and when He came from there to the village of Kuliyā, that sinner took shelter of Him. Moved by compassion, the Lord gave him beneficial instruction:

57 "You have offended Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita. Go to him; if he shows you mercy,

58 then you will be freed from this sin — if you never act like this again."

59 Then the brāhmaṇa came and took shelter of Śrīvāsa, and by his mercy he was freed from the sin.

60 Another brāhmaṇa came to see the *kīrtana*, but the doors were shut, and he could not get in.

61 The brāhmaṇa went home aggrieved. The next day, seeing the Lord at the Gaṅgā, he said to Him:

62 "I will curse You — I have been hurt!" And tearing his sacred thread, that fierce, foul-mouthed man cursed Him:

63 "May Your worldly happiness be destroyed!" Hearing the curse, Mahāprabhu was delighted.

64 One who hears with faith the account of the Lord's curse is protected from the curse of brāhmaṇas.

65 He gave Mukunda Datta the mercy of punishment and removed all the dejection from his heart.

66 The Lord showed Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi the devotion due to a guru, and this grieved the Ācārya greatly.

67 So, by a ruse, he expounded the path of knowledge, and the Lord, in anger, treated him with disrespect.

68 Then Ācārya Gosāñi was filled with joy, and the Lord, abashed, showed him mercy.

69 Hearing Rāma's many glories from the mouth of Murāri Gupta, the Lord wrote on his forehead the name "Rāmadāsa" (servant of Rāma).

70 He drank water from Śrīdhara's iron pot, and He granted all the devotees the boons they desired.

71 He showed mercy to Haridāsa Ṭhākura, and He freed His mother from her offense against Advaita Ācārya.

72 The Lord spoke to the devotees about the glory of the Name. Hearing it, a student there called it *arthavāda* (exaggerated praise).

73 Hearing the Name's glories called mere praise, the Lord was pained, and He told everyone: "Do not look at this man's face!"

74 With His associates He went and bathed in the Gaṅgā with His clothes on, and there He explained the glory of devotion.

75 Kṛṣṇa is not brought under control by knowledge, *karma*, *yoga* or religious duty. Only one thing brings Kṛṣṇa under control: the *rasa* of love for Him.

76 “O Uddhava, neither *yoga*, nor *sāṅkhya*, nor religious duty, nor Vedic study, austerity or renunciation brings Me under control as does strong devotion to Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.14.20)

77 The Lord said to Murāri, “You have brought Kṛṣṇa under your control.” Hearing this, Murāri began to recite a verse:

78 “Who am I — poor and most sinful — and who is Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the goddess of fortune? Yet I, a brāhmaṇa in name only, was embraced in His arms.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.81.16)

79 One day the Lord performed *saṅkīrtana* with all His devotees and then sat down, tired.

80 The Lord planted a mango seed in the courtyard. At once it sprouted, and a tree began to grow.

81 Before their eyes the tree began to bear fruit; many fruits ripened, and everyone was amazed.

82 The Lord quickly had some two hundred fruits picked, washed them and offered them to Kṛṣṇa.

83 They were red and yellow, without stone or skin, and one fruit would fill a man’s stomach.

84 Seeing them, the son of Śacī was pleased. He tasted them first and then fed everyone.

85 Without stone or skin, they were full of nectarean juice; eating one fruit filled the stomach with its juice.

86 In this way the tree bore fruit every day for twelve months, and the Vaiṣṇavas ate it, to the Lord's delight.

87 The son of Śacī performed all these pastimes, but no one knew of them except His devotees.

88 Thus for twelve months, at the end of each *kīrtana*, the Lord held a festival of mangoes day after day.

89 Once, while the Lord was performing *kīrtana*, clouds gathered, and by His own will He dispersed them.

90 One day the Lord said to Śrīvāsa: "Read the great *Sahasra-nāma* (the Thousand Names); I wish to hear it."

91 As he read, he came in the hymn to the name of Nṛsiṁha; hearing it, the Lord, the abode of all virtues, was overwhelmed.

92 In the mood of Nṛsiṁha the Lord took a club in His hand and ran into the town to strike down the unbelievers.

93 Seeing Him absorbed in Nṛsiṁha's mood and blazing with power, people left the road and fled in great fear.

94 Seeing the people's fear, the Lord returned to outer awareness; He went to Śrīvāsa's house and threw down the club.

95 Dejected, the Lord said to Śrīvāsa: "The people were frightened — that is My offense."

96 Śrīvāsa said: "Whoever takes Your name — all his millions of offenses are destroyed.

97 There was no offense; You delivered the people. Whoever saw You was released from worldly bondage.”

98 Saying this, Śrīvāsa served Him, and the Lord, pleased, returned to His own home.

99 Another day a devotee of Śiva came singing Śiva’s glories; he danced in the Lord’s courtyard, playing a *ḍamaru* drum.

100 The son of Śacī became absorbed in the mood of Maheśa (Śiva); He climbed onto the man’s shoulders and danced for a long time.

101 Another day a beggar came for alms. Seeing the Lord dance, he began to dance too.

102 He danced with the Lord in supreme joy; the Lord gave him love of God, and he floated in its *rasa*.

103 Another day an omniscient astrologer came. The Lord honored him and asked:

104 “Who was I in My previous birth? Calculate and tell Me.” Hearing the Lord’s words, the omniscient man began to calculate.

105 Having calculated, he saw in meditation a form of great effulgence — the shelter of all, of the endless Vaikuṇṭhas and universes,

106 the Supreme Truth, the Supreme Brahman, the Supreme Lord. Seeing the Lord’s form, the omniscient man was bewildered.

107 He could say nothing and fell silent. The Lord asked again, and he began to speak:

108 “In Your previous birth You were the supreme shelter, the complete Bhagavān, full of all majesty.

109 As You were before, so You are now. Your true nature is eternal bliss, hard to understand.”

110 The Lord laughed and said: “You have understood nothing. Before, I was a cowherd by caste.

111 I was born in a cowherd’s house and tended the cows. By that merit I have now become a brāhmaṇa’s son.”

112 The omniscient man said: “That is what I saw in meditation, and seeing majesty in it, I was bewildered.

113 I see that form and this form as one. If ever I see a difference, that is by Your *māyā*.

114 Whoever You may be, I bow down to You.” The Lord rewarded him with love of God.

115 One day, sitting in the Viṣṇu pavilion, the Lord called out: “Bring honey! Bring honey!”

116 Nityānanda Gosāñi understood the Lord’s mood; He brought a vessel of Gaṅgā water and set it before Him.

117 The Lord drank the water and danced, overwhelmed, and everyone saw the pastime of drawing the Yamunā.

118 He moved with an intoxicated gait, like Baladeva, and Ācārya Śekhara (Candraśekhara) saw Him in the form of Rāma.

119 Vanamālī Ācārya saw a golden plough, and all danced together, overwhelmed with bliss.

120 So the dancing went on for four *praharas* (twelve hours); in the evening everyone bathed in the Gaṅgā and went home.

121 When the Lord gave the townspeople His order, they began to perform *saṅkīrtana* in every house:

122 "*Hari haraye namaḥ, kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ; gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana!*"

123 With *mṛdaṅgas* and *karatālas* the sound of *saṅkīrtana* was tremendous; no sound was heard but "Hari! Hari!"

124 Hearing it, all the Muslims grew angry; they went to the Kazi and lodged a complaint.

125 One evening the Kazi angrily came to a house, broke a *mṛdaṅga* and said to the people:

126 "Till now no one practiced Hindu rites openly. Now you press on with this effort — on whose strength, I would like to know?

127 No one in the whole town is to perform *kīrtana*. Today I forgive you and go home.

128 If I catch anyone performing *kīrtana* again, I will confiscate all he owns and take away his caste."

129 Saying this, the Kazi left, and the townspeople, deeply grieved, reported it to the Lord.

130 The Lord ordered: “Go and perform *kīrtana*! Today I shall destroy all the Muslims.”

131 Everyone went home and performed *kīrtana*, but out of fear of the Kazi they were not at ease; their minds were alarmed.

132 Knowing the fear in their hearts, the Lord quickly called the people together and said:

133 “Today I shall perform *kīrtana* through every part of the town. In the evening, all of you, decorate the town.

134 In the evening light lamps in every house. We shall see what Kazi comes to stop Me!”

135 Saying this, in the evening Gaurarāya set out. The Lord formed three groups of *kīrtana*.

136 In the front group Haridāsa danced; in the middle Ācārya Gosāñi danced in supreme joy.

137 In the last group Gauracandra danced, and Nityānanda Prabhu moved along dancing with Him.

138 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail in the *Caitanya-maṅgala* by the power of Caitanya’s mercy.

139 Performing *kīrtana* in this way, they wandered through the town, and wandering on, the Lord came to the Kazi’s door.

140 The people growled and roared and raised an uproar; emboldened by Gauracandra’s strength, they were wild.

141 At the sound of the *kīrtana* the Kazi hid in his house; hearing the growling and roaring, he would not come out.

142 Unruly people wrecked the Kazi's house and flower garden. Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail.

143 Then Mahāprabhu sat down at his door and sent respectable men to call the Kazi.

144 The Kazi came from a distance with his head bowed. The Lord received him with honor and had him sit down.

145 The Lord said: "I have come to you as a guest, yet seeing Me, you hid. What kind of etiquette is this?"

146 The Kazi said: "You came in anger. I stayed hidden so that You might grow calm.

147 Now that You are calm, I have come to meet You. How fortunate I am to have such a guest as You!

148 By village relationship Cakravartī is my uncle, and a village relationship is stronger than a blood relationship.

149 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī is Your maternal grandfather; by that relationship You are my nephew.

150 An uncle surely tolerates his nephew's anger, and a nephew does not take offense at his uncle."

151 So the two spoke in hints and allusions, and no one could understand the inner meaning.

152 The Lord said, “I have come to you to ask some questions.” The Kazi said, “Command me — ask whatever is in Your mind.”

153 The Lord said: “You drink cow’s milk, so the cow is your mother; the bull produces grain, so he is your father.

154 You kill and eat your father and mother — what kind of religion is that? On what authority do you commit such a sinful act?”

155 The Kazi said: “As You have the Vedas and Purāṇas, so we have our scripture, the book called the Korān.

156 That scripture distinguishes two paths: engagement in the world (*pravṛtti*) and renunciation (*nivṛtti*). On the path of renunciation the killing of any living being is forbidden.

157 On the path of engagement there is an injunction to kill cows, and if the killing is done by scriptural order, there is no fear of sin.

158 Your Vedas too speak of killing cows; that is why great sages killed cows.”

159 The Lord said: “The Vedas forbid the killing of cows; that is why no Hindu kills a cow.

160 One may kill a living being only if one can bring it back to life; there is such an injunction in the Vedas and Purāṇas.

161 So the sages would kill an old cow and by Vedic mantras make its life perfect again.

162 The old cow became young once more; so for it this was not killing but a benefit.

163 In the age of Kali brāhmaṇas have no such power; therefore no one kills cows now.

164 “In the age of Kali one should give up five things: the horse sacrifice, the sacrifice of a cow, *sannyāsa*, the offering of flesh to the forefathers, and begetting a son by a husband’s brother.” (Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa, Kṛṣṇa-janma-khaṇḍa 185.180)

165 You cannot bring them back to life; killing is all you do. There is no deliverance from hell for you.

166 One who kills a cow rots in the hell Raurava for as many thousands of years as there are hairs on the cow’s body.

167 The compiler of your scripture was mistaken too: not knowing the heart of scripture, he gave such an order.”

168 Hearing this, the Kazi was stunned and could find no words. After reflecting, he admitted defeat and said:

169 “What You have said, Paṇḍita, is true. Our scripture is recent and cannot bear scrutiny.

170 Our scripture is invented — I know all this. Yet out of regard for my community I accept it.

171 By its very nature, the reasoning in the Muslims’ scripture is unsound.” Smiling at this, Mahāprabhu asked him once more:

172 “I have one more question; listen, uncle. Answer truthfully and do not deceive Me with tricks.

173 In your town there is always *saṅkīrtana* — a tumult of instruments and songs, music and dancing.

174 You are the Kazi, with authority to oppose Hindu practices. Why you do not stop it now, I cannot understand.”

175 The Kazi said: “Everyone calls You Gaurahari, so by that name I shall address You.

176 Listen, Gaurahari: if we are alone, I shall tell You the reason in answer to this question.”

177 The Lord said: “These people are My intimate associates. Speak openly and do not be afraid.”

178–179 The Kazi said: “When I went to a Hindu’s house, broke a *mṛdaṅga* and forbade the *kīrtana*, that night a most terrifying lion came, with a human body and a lion’s face, roaring loudly.

180 As I lay in bed, it leapt up onto me, laughing fiercely and gnashing its teeth.

181 Setting its claws on my chest, it said in a dreadful voice: ‘I will tear open your chest in return for the *mṛdaṅga*!

182 You forbid My *kīrtana* — I will destroy you!’ I shut my eyes and trembled in great fear.

183 Seeing me afraid, the lion grew kind and said: ‘I have defeated you only to teach you a lesson.

184 That day you did not cause much trouble, so I forgive you and have not taken your life.

185 If you do such a thing again, I will not tolerate it: I will destroy you with your whole family, and the Muslims too.’

186 Saying this, the lion went away, and I was left in fear. Look — here are the marks of its claws on my chest!”

187 Saying this, the Kazi showed his chest. Hearing his words and seeing the marks, everyone was amazed.

188 The Kazi said: “I have told this to no one. That same day one of my constables came to me

189 and said: ‘I went to forbid the *kīrtana*, and suddenly a firebrand struck my face.

190 My whole beard was burned, and my face was blistered.’ Every constable who went told the same story.

191 Seeing this, I was seized with great fear; I no longer forbid the *kīrtana*, but stay sitting at home.

192 Then *kīrtana* could go on freely in the town. Hearing of it, all the *mlecchas* (Muslims) came and complained:

193 ‘The Hindus’ religion has grown beyond bounds in the town; we hear no sound but “Hari! Hari!”’

194 Another *mleccha* said: ‘The Hindus cry “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!” — they laugh, weep, dance, sing and roll in the dust.

195 Crying “Hari! Hari!” the Hindus raise an uproar. If the king hears of it, he will punish you.’

196 Then I asked those Muslims: ‘That a Hindu says “Hari” — I know that is his nature.

197 But you are Muslims — why do you constantly take the name of the Hindus’ God?’

198 One *mleccha* said: ‘I make fun of the Hindus. Some of them are Kṛṣṇadāsa, some Rāmadāsa,

199 some Haridāsa, and they always say “Hari! Hari!” — I thought they meant to steal (*hari*) someone’s wealth.

200 Since then my tongue says “Hari! Hari!” I don’t want it to, yet it does — what can I do?’

201–202 Another *mleccha* said: ‘Listen: I too mocked the Hindus like this, and since that day my tongue chants the name of Kṛṣṇa and will not be held back. I don’t know what spells and herbs the Hindus know.’

203 Hearing this, I sent them all home. Just then five or seven unbelieving Hindus came.

204 They said: ‘Nimāi has broken the Hindu religion. He has started a *kīrtana* we have never heard of.

205 When we keep night vigils for Maṅgalacaṇḍī or Viṣahari, then dancing, singing and music are proper.

206 This Nimāi Paṇḍita used to be good, but since He came back from Gayā He behaves the opposite way.

207 He sings loudly and claps His hands; the sound of *mṛdaṅgas* and *karatālas* deafens our ears.

208 We don’t know what He has eaten that He dances and sings like a madman, laughs, weeps, falls, gets up and rolls about.

209 With constant *saṅkīrtana* He has made the townspeople mad. At night we cannot sleep; we lie awake.

210 He has dropped the name Nimāi and now calls Himself Gaurahari. He has ruined the Hindu religion by spreading unbelief.

211 He performs *kīrtana* of Kṛṣṇa, and the low-born are rising higher and higher. For this sin Navadvīpa will be laid waste.

212 In Hindu scripture we know the name of God to be the great *mantra*; if everyone hears it, the *mantra* loses its power.

213 You are the lord of the town; all the people are yours. Summon Nimāi and banish Him.’

214 Then I spoke kindly to them all: ‘Go home, all of you; I will stop Him.’

215 The great God of the Hindus is Nārāyaṇa, and my mind tells me that You are He.”

216 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu, smiling broadly, touched the Kazi and said:

217 “The name of Kṛṣṇa in your mouth — this is most wonderful! Your sins are destroyed, and you have become supremely pure.

218 You have uttered three names — Hari, Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa. You are most fortunate and most pious.”

219 Hearing this, the Kazi wept, and touching the Lord’s feet, he spoke these sweet words:

220 “By Your mercy my evil mind is gone. Grant me this mercy: may my devotion remain fixed on You.”

221 The Lord said: “I ask one gift of you: let there be no obstruction to *saṅkīrtana* in Nadīyā.”

222 The Kazi said: “I will bind everyone born in my line by a solemn oath (*tālāka*) never to obstruct the *kīrtana*.”

223 Hearing this, the Lord rose, saying “Hari!”, and all the Vaiṣṇavas rose, raising the sound of “Hari!”

224 The Lord set off performing *kīrtana*, and the Kazi walked along with Him, rejoicing at heart.

225 The son of Śacī bade the Kazi farewell and, dancing all the way, returned to His own home.

226 Thus the Lord showed mercy to the Kazi. Whoever hears this is freed from offenses.

227 One day in Śrīvāsa’s house the Lord was dancing with Nityānanda — the two brothers together.

228 There Śrīvāsa’s son passed to the other world, yet no grief arose in Śrīvāsa’s heart.

229 Through the mouth of the departed son the Lord had spiritual knowledge spoken, and the two brothers Themselves became Śrīvāsa’s sons.

230 Then He granted boons to all the devotees, and He honored Nārāyaṇī by giving her His remnants.

231 A Muslim tailor sewed clothes for Śrīvāsa, and the Lord granted him the sight of His own form.

232 Crying “I have seen! I have seen!” he went mad, danced in love and became a foremost Vaiṣṇava.

233 In ecstasy the Lord asked Śrīvāsa for His flute. Śrīvāsa said, “The *gopīs* have stolen Your flute.”

234 Hearing this, the Lord said in ecstasy, “Tell on! Tell on!”, and Śrīvāsa described the *rasa* of the Vṛndāvana pastimes.

235 First he described the sweetness of Vṛndāvana, and as the Lord heard it, the joy in His heart increased.

236 Then the Lord said again and again, “Tell on! Tell on!”, and Śrīvāsa spoke again and again, in ever greater detail:

237 how the music of the flute drew the *gopīs* into the forest, and how Kṛṣṇa wandered in the forest with them.

238 Within that he described the pastimes of the six seasons, the drinking of honey, the festival of the *rāsa* dance and the sports in the water.

239 “Tell on! Tell on!” said the Lord, delighted to hear, and Śrīvāsa then told of the *rāsa* dance and its play of *rasa*.

240 As one spoke and the other listened, morning came. The Lord gratified Śrīvāsa by embracing him.

241 Then in the house of the Ācārya (Candraśekhara) He enacted Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes, Himself taking the parts of Rukmiṇī and others.

242 Sometimes He became Durgā or Lakṣmī, sometimes the spiritual energy (*cit-śakti*); seated on a cot, He gave the devotees loving devotion.

243 One day, when Mahāprabhu's dancing ended, a brāhmaṇa lady came and clasped His feet.

244 Again and again she took the dust of His feet. Seeing this, the Lord was immeasurably distressed.

245 At once the Lord ran and threw Himself into the Gaṅgā; Nityānanda and Haridāsa caught hold of Him and lifted Him out.

246 That night He stayed in the house of Vijaya Ācārya, and in the morning He went home, taking all the devotees with Him.

247 One day, sitting at home in the mood of a *gopī*, the Lord was sorrowfully repeating, "Gopī! Gopī!"

248 A student came to see the Lord. Hearing Him say "Gopī! Gopī!", he said:

249 "Why don't You take the name of Kṛṣṇa? The name of Kṛṣṇa is blessed. What merit is there in saying 'Gopī! Gopī!'?"

250 Hearing this, the Lord angrily poured out complaints against Kṛṣṇa, and taking up a stick, He rose to beat the student.

251 The student fled in fear with the Lord running after him, and the devotees hurriedly held the Lord back.

252 Calming the Lord, they brought Him home, and the student ran off to the assembly of students.

253 Going where a thousand students studied together, the brāhmaṇa told them what had happened with the Lord.

254 Hearing it, all the students grew angry, and together they began to revile the Lord:

255 “Nimāi alone has corrupted the whole country. He wants to beat a brāhmaṇa — He has no fear of dharma!

256 If He does such a thing again, we will beat Him. What sort of man is He? What can He do?”

257 By reviling the Lord they all lost their intelligence; the learning they had studied so well no longer shone in any of them.

258 Still the proud students did not become humble; everywhere they laughed and reviled the Lord.

259 The omniscient Lord knew the plight that awaited them all, and sitting at home, He thought of how to deliver them:

260 “All these teachers and their students are given to religious duties, to fruitive works and to austerity, yet they are blasphemers and wicked.

261 Because of their offense in reviling Me, they cannot take up devotion unless I make them take it.

262 I came to deliver them, but the opposite has happened. How will these wicked people be benefited?

263 If they bow down to Me, their sins will be destroyed; then they will take up devotion when I give it.

264 Those who revile Me and do not bow down to Me — these souls I must surely deliver.

265 Therefore I shall certainly accept *sannyāsa*; thinking of Me as a *sannyāsī*, they will bow down to Me.

266 By bowing down their offenses will be destroyed, and in their purified hearts I will make devotion arise.

267 Then these unbelievers will be delivered. There is no other means — this is the essence of My reasoning."

268 Having firmly resolved this, the Lord stayed at home. Then Keśava Bhāratī came to the town of Nadīyā.

269 The Lord bowed to him and invited him, and after feeding him, He made a request:

270 "You are indeed a lord — Nārāyaṇa in person. Be merciful and release Me from worldly life."

271 Bhāratī said: "You are God, the knower of every heart. Whatever You say, I will do; I am not independent."

272 Saying this, Bhāratī Gosāñi went to Kāṭoyā, and Mahāprabhu went there and accepted *sannyāsa*.

273 With Him were Nityānanda, Candraśekhara Ācārya and Mukunda Datta; these three performed all the necessary duties.

274 Thus I have listed the Ādi-līlā in summary; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described it in detail.

275 The son of Yaśodā has become the son of Śacī, and He tastes the four kinds of devotees' moods.

276 To taste His own sweetness and the *rasa* of Rādhā's love, He has fully accepted Rādhā's mood.

277 Because the Lord has wholly taken the *gopīs'* mood, He regards the son of the king of Vraja as His beloved.

278 This is the firm conviction of the *gopīs'* love: it cannot exist toward anyone but the son of the king of Vraja —

279 Śyāmasundara, adorned with a peacock feather and *guñjā* berries, dressed as a cowherd, His body bent in three places, the flute at His lips.

280 If Kṛṣṇa leaves this form and takes another, the *gopīs'* love does not even go near Him.

281 "What wise man can understand the course of the *gopīs'* love for the son of the king of the cowherds — love that moves on a path hard to fathom? Even when He reveals a form of Viṣṇu, wondrously beautiful with four victorious arms, alas, their rising love shrinks away." (Lalita-mādhava 6.14)

282 In spring, while performing the *rāsa* dance near Govardhana, Kṛṣṇa disappeared, having made a secret sign to Rādhā.

283 Sitting in a secluded bower, He watched the path for Rādhā. Searching for Him, a crowd of *gopīs* came there.

284 Seeing Kṛṣṇa from afar, the *gopīs* said, "Look, there in the bower is the son of the king of Vraja!"

285 Seeing the *gopīs*, Kṛṣṇa was alarmed; He could not hide, and fear overpowered Him.

286 Assuming a four-armed form, He remained seated. Seeing Kṛṣṇa so, the *gopīs* came near and said:

287 “This is not Kṛṣṇa; this is a form of Nārāyaṇa.” Saying this, they all bowed to Him and offered prayers:

288 “Obeisance to Nārāyaṇa! O Lord, be gracious: grant us Kṛṣṇa’s company and dispel our sorrow.”

289 Saying this, the *gopīs* bowed and went away. Just then Rādhā came into view.

290 Seeing Rādhā, Kṛṣṇa wanted to keep that four-armed form to play a joke on Her.

291 But before Rādhā two of His arms vanished; Kṛṣṇa tried hard, but could not keep them.

292 Such is the inconceivable power of Rādhā’s pure love: it brought Kṛṣṇa back to His natural two-armed form.

293 “At the beginning of the *rāsa* dance Hari hid in a bower. When the doe-eyed *gopīs* found Him, He cleverly displayed a four-armed form to conceal Himself. But behold the greatness of Rādhā’s love: before its splendor even the all-powerful Hari could not keep His four arms.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Nāyikā-bheda 7)

294 That king of Vraja is now Jagannātha, the father; that queen of Vraja is now Śacīdevī, the mother.

295 That son of Nanda is now Caitanya Gosāñi; that Baladeva is now His brother Nityānanda.

296 Full of three moods — parental affection, servitude and friendship — that Nityānanda is the helper of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

297 Giving loving devotion, He flooded the world. People cannot understand His wonderful character.

298 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the incarnation as a devotee. Bringing Kṛṣṇa down to this world, He preached devotion.

299 Friendship and servitude — these two moods are natural to Him. Sometimes the Lord treats Him as His guru.

300 Śrīvāsa and all of Mahāprabhu's other devotees serve Caitanya, each in his own mood.

301 Whatever the *rasa* of each — of Paṇḍita Gosāñi (Gadādhara) and the others — by that *rasa* the Lord comes under his control.

302 There He was dark, the flute at His lips, sporting as a cowherd; here He is golden — sometimes a brāhmaṇa, sometimes a *sannyāsī*.

303 Therefore the Lord Himself, taking the *gopīs'* mood, calls the son of the king of Vraja "Lord of My life."

304 He is Kṛṣṇa, and He is a *gopī* — a supreme contradiction. The Lord's inconceivable character is very hard to understand.

305 Let no one raise doubts about this by reasoning: such is Kṛṣṇa's inconceivable power.

306 Inconceivable and wondrous are the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — wonderful His moods, wonderful His qualities, wonderful His conduct.

307 The wicked man who rejects this on the strength of logic rots in the hell Kumbhīpāka; there is no deliverance for him.

308 “Matters that are inconceivable should not be approached by logic. What lies beyond material nature — that is the mark of the inconceivable.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 2.5.93)

309 Whoever has faith in Caitanya’s wondrous pastimes comes to Caitanya’s feet.

310 In the course of the narration I have told the essence of this conclusion. Whoever hears it attains pure devotion.

311 If I repeat what has been written in the book, then its meaning will be relished.

312 That is why in the *Bhāgavata* Vyāsa, having told a story, repeats it again and again.

313 So I list the chapters of the Ādi-līlā. In the first chapter I gave the auspicious invocation.

314 In the second chapter, the establishment of the truth about Caitanya: that the son of the king of Vraja, Bhagavān Himself,

315 is Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa, the son of Śacī. In the third chapter, the general reason for His birth;

316 within it also the special reason, the giving of love, and the religion of the age — the spreading of Kṛṣṇa’s name and of love.

317 In the fourth I told the root reason for His birth: to taste the *rasa* of His own sweetness and of the bliss of love.

318 In the fifth, the establishment of the truth about Śrī Nityānanda: Nityānanda is Rāma, the son of Rohiṇī.

319 In the sixth chapter, the examination of the truth about Advaita: Advaita Ācārya is the incarnation of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

320 In the seventh chapter, the account of the Pañca-tattva, and how the Pañca-tattva together gave away love of God.

321 In the eighth, the reason for describing Caitanya's pastimes, and the telling of the great glory of the one name of Kṛṣṇa.

322 In the ninth, the description of the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion, which Śrī Caitanya, the gardener, planted.

323 In the tenth, the enumeration of the branches of the main trunk, and how all the branches distribute the fruit.

324 In the eleventh, the account of Nityānanda's branches; in the twelfth, the description of the branches of the trunk Advaita.

325 In the thirteenth, the account of Mahāprabhu's birth — how the Lord was born together with the name of Kṛṣṇa.

326 In the fourteenth, some account of His childhood pastimes; in the fifteenth, a brief telling of His *paugaṇḍa* pastimes.

327 In the sixteenth I outlined the *kaiśora* pastimes; in the seventeenth I told especially of the pastimes of youth.

328 These are the seventeen sections of the Ādi-līlā; twelve of them form the preface to the book.

329 In five sections I have told the deeds of the five ages — very briefly, without going into detail.

330 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this in detail in the *Caitanya-maṅgala* by the power of Nityānanda's order.

331 The pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are wondrous and endless; even Brahmā, Śiva and Śeṣa cannot find their end.

332 Whoever tells any part of them and whoever hears it is blessed; Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya will soon meet him.

333 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, Advaita, Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara and all the devotees,

334 and all the devotees who live in Vṛndāvana — humbly I place the feet of them all upon my head.

335–336 Placing on my head the feet of Śrī Svarūpa, Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana, Śrī Raghunātha dāsa and Śrī Jīva, I bow to them and always place my hope in them. Thus Kṛṣṇadāsa tells the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.